

the enthusiastic bloggers good enough to be very visible representatives of your brand? I recommend you start low-profile. You could even consider to start behind the firewall or with a password-protected blog.

13. Start doing subtle PR

Don't issue a press release stating you have a blog. You wouldn't be the first to do it, but it never seems appropriate. There are other means.

14. Success or failure? Decide on the future of your blog

It doesn't take more than two or three months, from my experience, to find out if a blog is good enough to deliver results. Have you been linked to by other blogs? Is anyone commenting? Do you get feedback from your target group? You also know how much resources the blog really demands by now, which means you have all the information you need to make a long-term commitment. Or just give it up. For related links on some of these steps, see

<http://www.corporateblogging.info/2004/09/14-steps-to-your-business-blog.asp>

7.7 Weblogs: Realigning Business, Technology & Communication

Weblogs were started as an underground and alternative tool for self-expression but have become one of the most significant Internet developments since HTML. Often self-published, they are among the most well read pages on the World Wide Web, with a powerful voice and an influential effect. In fact, the voice has had such a far-reaching impact that it has been credited with fueling the publicity that led to the resignation of US Senate Majority Leader, Trent Lott. And now, weblogs are poised to exert a similar impact on the world of business.

This white paper looks at the rise of the weblog phenomenon and examines its potential effect on business, and how businesses